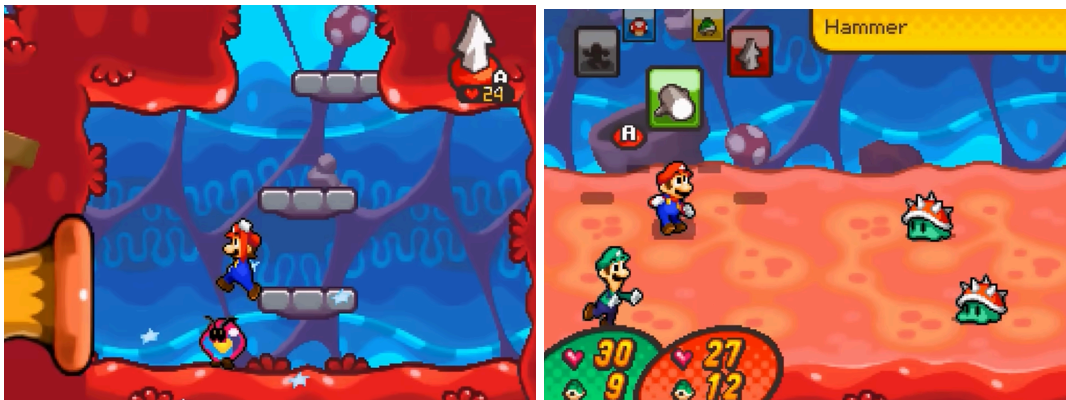


# The RPG Platformer

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## Abstract

The RPG Platformer is about a team of adventurers trying to traverse through the dangerous woods while fighting monsters along the way. In this game the player will select a character and traverse a platformer level to reach the end of the stage. Along the way, whenever the player comes in contact with an enemy a battle sequence will be triggered, pausing the platformer game play to let the player choose how it wishes to attack or defend from the enemies attack, as you would in a battle based RPG game. The hope is that this game will create a new form of gameplay experience by melding the active elements of a basic platformer with the strategic elements of a RPG battle through a seamless process that is entertaining and not jarring to the player.



Source: *Mario and Luigi: Bowser's Inside Story*

# Initial Design

## Core Mechanics

Play as two main characters, a Knight and a Mage. While Platforming, the Knight can destroy obstacles, and the Mage can jump higher. Whichever character is active while platforming will be brought into battle when an enemy is encountered.

During an encounter, a turn-based RPG battle will commence! Different enemies will have different attacks that different action commands can block, and both characters will have different playstyles depending on which enters combat.

Some harder enemies may also thrust you back into the platformer and have you dodge attacks there; however, they will only be damageable within the turn-based combat, so you will have to scramble to re-engage in combat.

## Visual Aesthetic

A fantasy aesthetic will be the inspiration for the characters and the environment. We will be using a 32bit pixel art style. We'd like to come up with a more interesting theme for the characters and world (like maybe all the characters are robots, or bugs, or bug-robots), but we haven't settled on one yet.

## User Interface

In all platformer elements there will be a basic informational layout on the screen presenting elements like player health and level progression, but overall minimizing the amount of extra UI information being shown.

## Music and Atmosphere

The hope is to make the forest feel dark and mysterious. As such, the music will probably be a simple soundtrack that loops, providing a sort of looming danger to the atmosphere. In addition, whenever a transition is made to a battle sequence, some form of a sound change will signal the heightened atmosphere, either by a completely new track or a sound effect for a few seconds. In addition, providing quick sound effects for all player attacks and

actions (like jumping, casting a spell, or swinging a sword) and major level changes to complete the immersion experience.

### Controls

Using the arrow keys or WASD, and space bar the player will move their character and jump from platform to platform. Then, when a battle sequence has begun the arrow keys or WASD will be used to navigate the UI menu options. We also intend to add controller support.

### Target Audience

People who are fans of either metroidvania-style games or turn-based action RPGs. Specifically fans of games like the Mario and Luigi RPG series.

### Additional Features

The hope is to make the transition back and forth between platformer elements and RPG elements as seamless as possible to keep the player immersed in the game. That said, the way this is done could change from encounter to encounter, so each enemy might have a slightly different way of melding these two genres together.

## Initial Development Tasks

- Create basic Unity project environment
- Set up a git hub directory
- Create a starting basic platformer and RPG environment.
  - Initially independent of each other, and will implement the connection later
- Create basic player designs and mechanics
  - Including adding necessary input support
- Design Simple UI environment for both the platformer and RPG environments, as well as a simple menu, settings, and level select.